

S.3 HISTORY

Final Examination — Intensive Study Notes

International Conflicts & Crises in the 20th Century — The Two World Wars

Examination Coverage

Textbook pp. 21–48 — International relations & the road to the Second World War

Textbook pp. 64–79 — Wars and inventions: total war, new warfare & technology

Textbook p. 122 — Berlin Blockade (*map only*)

+ Revision Exercises 7–12 — incl. the Eastern Front & Asia-Pacific theatre of WWII

How to use these notes

Bold terms are the names, dates and concepts most likely to be tested. Tables compare items the exam likes to contrast (e.g. the Big Three, the three totalitarian regimes).

All maps and graphs are taken from your textbook photos and revision exercises — study them; data-based questions (DBQ) are built directly on them.

Yellow boxes are the completed Final Revision Notes (Research Exercises 7–12): each shows the worksheet's picture plus the exact answers (in red), so you can revise the whole exercise in one place.

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Quick-Reference: Key Points to Memorise

Every list the exam likes to ask for — **causes, aims, features, impacts** — in one place. Numbers in brackets show how many points to give.

Topic (what's asked)	The points to remember
Problems left by WWI → causes of WWII (3)	(1) Failure of the Paris Peace Conference; (2) economic problems in the inter-war period; (3) the rise of totalitarianism.
Aims of the Big Three (3)	• Wilson (US) — maintain world peace; • Clemenceau (France) — weaken Germany; • Lloyd George (Britain) — keep a balance of power.
Terms of the Treaty of Versailles (4 groups)	• Responsibility (war-guilt clause); • Reparations (6.6 billion pounds); • Disarmament (army 100,000; no tanks/subs/aircraft; Rhineland demilitarised); • Territorial (Alsace-Lorraine, the 'Polish Corridor', all colonies, no union with Austria).
Impact of the Great Depression (4 actors)	• US — isolationism; • Britain & France — reluctant to use force; • Germany — support for Hitler; • Japan — militarist expansion.
The 3 regimes (Party – Leader – Symbol)	Fascism — Fascist Party / Mussolini / fasces; Nazism — Nazi Party / Hitler / swastika; Militarism — Shintoism / Tojo Hideki & Emperor Showa / Rising sun.
Aggressions of the 1930s	Italy — Abyssinia (1935); Germany — Rhineland (1936), Anschluss (1938), Sudetenland (1938); Japan — Manchuria (1931), Manzhouguo (1932), Lugouqiao (1937).
Formation of the Axis (3 pacts)	• Anti-Comintern Pact (1936); • Pact of Steel (1939); • Tripartite Pact (1940) — the Berlin–Rome–Tokyo Axis.
Why collective security failed (4)	• League of Nations too weak (US never joined); • Britain & France appeasement; • US isolationism; • the USSR drawn to Germany (Nazi–Soviet Pact).

Topic (what's asked)	The points to remember
Impacts of total war on people (3)	Political — loss of freedom; Economic — shortages & inflation; Social — heavier civilian casualties + rise in women's position.
Three-dimensional warfare — WWI (3)	Land (trenches, tanks, gas); Sea (dreadnoughts, U-boats); Air (fighter planes, Zeppelins).
New WWII armaments (4)	Nuclear weapons; bomber aircraft; rockets; aircraft carriers.
Impacts of military innovation (3)	Unprecedented casualties; huge economic losses; continuing threats to peace (nuclear age).
War-driven technology (6 areas)	Aviation/aerospace; info & communications; materials; medicine; daily tools; energy.
Impacts of WWII — DBQ 3 (3)	Casualties & destruction; the start of the nuclear age; rise of the two superpowers & decline of Europe (+ the UN, decolonisation).
Why WWII was deadlier than WWI (2)	Larger area of fighting (Asia-Pacific too); more destructive weapons (the atomic bomb).

PART A — Why did the Second World War happen? (pp. 21–48)

Big picture: WWI ended in 1918, but the peace settlements did not solve the powers' conflicts — some even **sowed the seeds of the next war**. Post-war economic problems and the Great Depression then weakened collective security and let totalitarian states (Italy, Germany, Japan) rise and expand. When the other powers failed to stop them, aggression continued until Germany invaded Poland in 1939 and the Second World War began.

A1 · Problems left behind by the First World War

- **Three lasting problems after WWI:** (1) failure of the Paris Peace Conference; (2) economic problems in the inter-war period; (3) the rise of totalitarianism. Together they led to WWII.
- **The two world wars were closely related** — WWII is often regarded as a continuation of WWI.

A2 · Failure of the Paris Peace Conference (1919)

(i) Calling of the conference

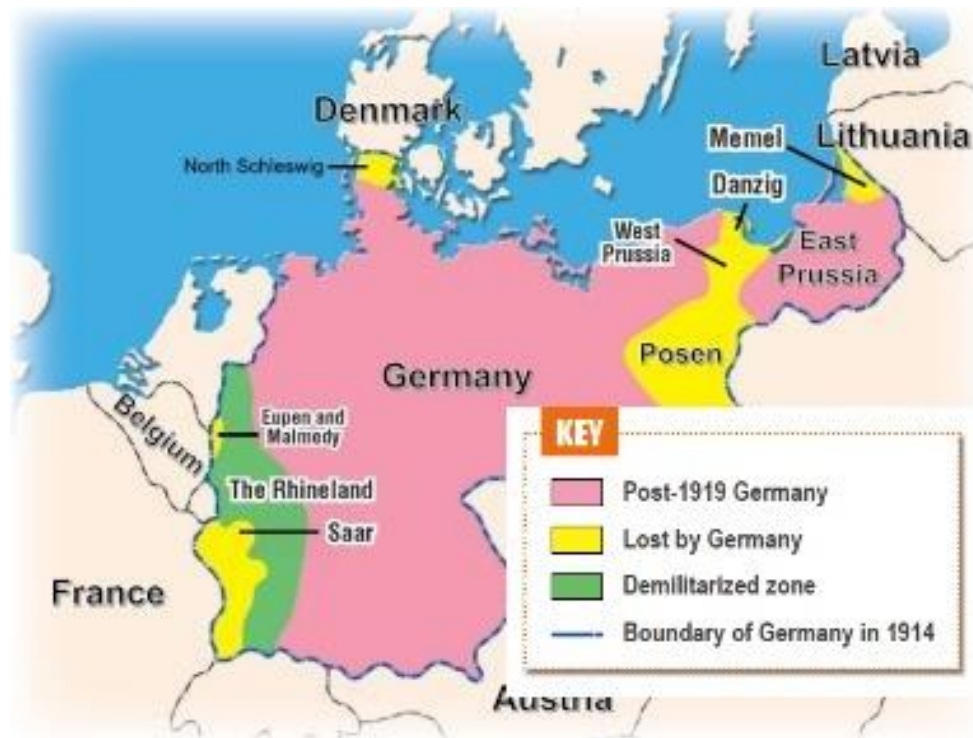
- In 1919, the victorious countries met in Paris to decide the peace settlement. The **United States, Britain and France** dominated it and were called the '**Big Three**'.
- Defeated countries were **not invited**; they signed separate treaties (1919–1920) and were punished — **Germany most heavily**.

(ii) The Big Three and their aims (Source 9.13)

Leader (country)	Aim	Key demands / position
Wilson — US President	To maintain world peace	Proposed the Fourteen Points as the basis of the settlement; opposed punishing Germany too harshly (to avoid deepening enmity)
Clemenceau — French PM	To weaken Germany permanently	Wanted back the land lost in the Franco-Prussian War; demanded harsh punishment so Germany could never threaten France again
Lloyd George — British PM	To maintain a balance of power	Did not want Germany weakened too much; wanted German colonies and to keep Britain's naval supremacy

(iii) Major settlements

- **Signing the Treaty of Versailles (June 1919):** Germany had to disarm, pay reparations, cede land, and accept the war-guilt clause (full responsibility for the war).
- **Achieving national self-determination:** defeated empires ceded land to the peoples of Eastern Europe; new nation-states (e.g. Hungary, Czechoslovakia, Poland) were created.
- **Forming a collective security system:** Wilson's proposal was adopted — the League of Nations was set up in 1920 to keep peace through collective security.



Map: The main territorial terms of the Treaty of Versailles

Source: Treaty of Versailles map (textbook p. 25). KEY — pink: post-1919 Germany; yellow: land lost by Germany; green: demilitarized zone; dashed line: 1914 border.

EXAM FOCUS — Terms of the Treaty of Versailles (memorise; DBQ favourite)

Military: army cut to 100,000; no tanks, submarines or fighter aircraft; the Rhineland made a demilitarized zone.

Reparations: 6.6 billion pounds, paid over 42 years.

Territorial: ceded 13% of land (e.g. Alsace-Lorraine to France; West Prussia/Posen to Poland; the 'Polish Corridor'); lost all overseas colonies; forbidden to unite with Austria.

Responsibility: accept the war-guilt clause (foundation of the other terms).

Group the impacts as Military / Economic / Territorial — exactly how DBQ 1 asks for them.

◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 7: The Treaty of Versailles (answers)

I. Responsibility for the War

- Germany accepted full responsibility for the War — the **war-guilt clause**.

II. Reparations

- Pay **6.6 billion pounds** in reparations to the Allied Powers.

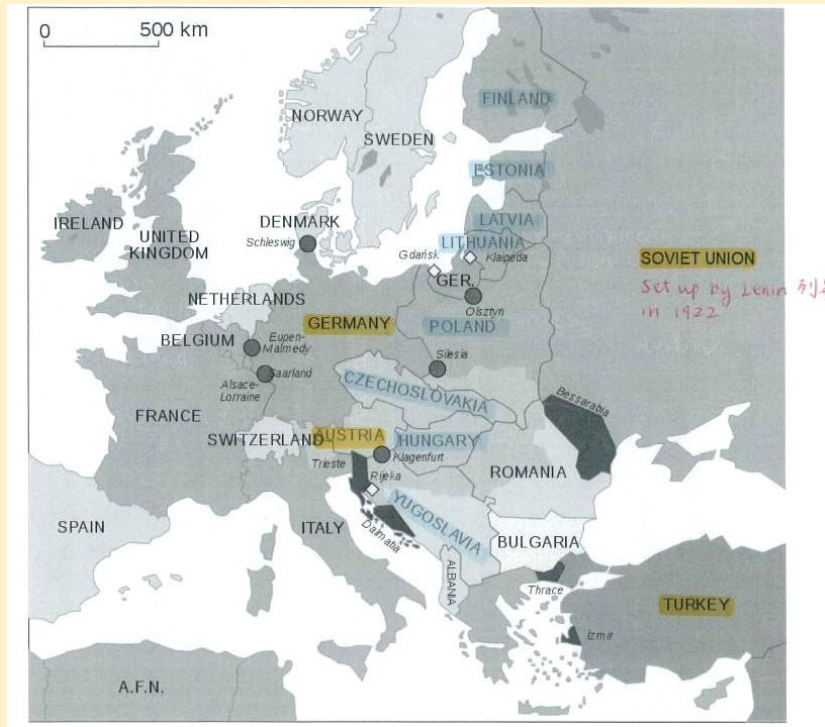
III. Disarmament

- Army cut to **100,000**; no **tanks**, submarines or fighter aircraft; the **Rhineland** made a demilitarised zone.

IV. Territorial Losses

- Ceded 13% of land: **Alsace-Lorraine** (to France); the "**Polish Corridor**" (to Poland).
- Gave up all overseas **colonies**; forbidden to unite with **Austria**.

◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 8: Territorial changes in Europe after WWI (answers)



The territorial expansion of the Allies

- France gained **Alsace-Lorraine**; Italy gained **Dalmatia and Trieste**.

The downfall of the empires

- **Germany, Austria-Hungary, Russia, the Ottoman Empire (Turkey).**

The rise of nation-states

- Examples: **Finland, Poland, Czechoslovakia, Hungary**, etc.
- Note (handwritten on the map): the **Soviet Union (USSR)** was **set up by Lenin** in 1922 — a new state formed after the fall of the Russian Empire.

(iv) Discontent of Italy and Germany

- **Italy — failed to get all the lands promised:** felt betrayed by its allies; blamed its government; wanted a strong leader to bring national glory.
- **Germany — punished too harshly:** felt the Treaty was unfair (esp. the war-guilt clause); wanted revenge; discontented with the Weimar Republic; longed for a strong leader to overthrow the Treaty.

(v) Hidden dangers in national self-determination

- New Eastern European states were weak and easily became targets of expansion.
- Their populations still included other peoples — e.g. **3 million Germans lived in the Sudetenland, Czechoslovakia**, which later became Germany's excuse for expansion.

A3 · Economic problems in the inter-war period

(i) Economic downturn after WWI

- Severe economic and social problems: high unemployment (demobilised soldiers), shortage of resources, damaged factories/infrastructure, serious inflation and famine.
- Countries did not cooperate; they **restricted foreign trade to protect their own industries**. The downturn sowed the seeds of totalitarianism.

History in Depth — Hyperinflation in Germany (early 1920s)

The Weimar Republic printed huge amounts of banknotes, causing hyperinflation between 1921 and 1923. Money became almost worthless (banknotes used as toys / waste paper).

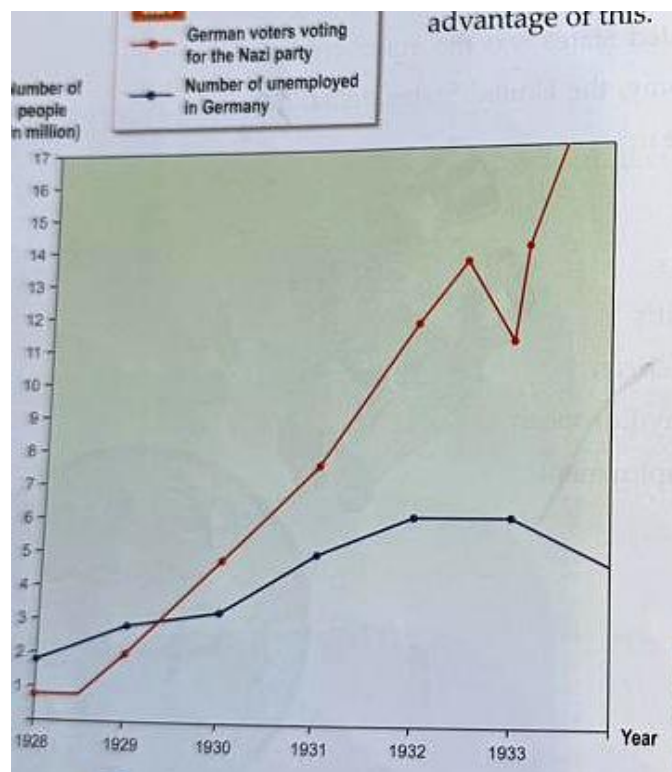
In 1924 the government issued a new currency and stopped over-printing, so the problem was gradually resolved.

(ii) The Great Depression (1929–1933)

- **The Wall Street Crash:** the US economy boomed 1919–1929 with heavy borrowing and stock speculation. In October 1929 a massive sell-off crashed the stock market — about 100,000 companies closed and unemployment reached 13 million.
- **Spread of the Depression:** the US was the major creditor of Europe; it demanded loan repayment and raised tariffs/quotas. American demand fell, so European and Japanese factories closed and unemployment soared. “When America sneezes, the world catches a cold.”

(iii) Impact of the Great Depression

- Weakened the international community's ability to keep peace and **fuelled the rise of totalitarianism**.
- **United States:** became self-isolated; passed neutrality acts.
- **Britain & France:** badly hit; reluctant to use force — aggressors took advantage.
- **Germany & Japan:** economic slump → Germans supported Hitler & the Nazi Party; in Japan, militarists proposed territorial expansion to solve the crisis.



Graph: Unemployment vs Nazi votes in Germany (1928–1933)

Source 9.18 (textbook p. 28). As unemployment rose, votes for the Nazi Party rose with it — the two lines climb together.

A4 · Rise of totalitarianism (pp. 29–35)

- **What is totalitarianism?** An ideology / political system in which the ruler holds total authority over the state and controls all aspects of public and private life.
- **Why it rose:** post-WWI instability weakened faith in democracy; Germans & Italians resented the Paris Peace Conference; people wanted a strong government to revive national glory. → Fascism (Italy), Nazism (Germany); in Japan, weak party government let militarists take over in the 1930s.

Totalitarianism vs Democracy (Source 9.19)

Aspect	Totalitarianism (Germany & Italy)	Democracy (Britain & France)
Governance	Ruler governed by his own will	Government ruled by law and the will of the people
Power	Power concentrated in the ruler; no checks and balances	Separation of powers; checks and balances
Parties	One-party system; opposition eliminated	Free to form parties; democratic elections
People's rights	Secret police; media strictly censored	Freedom of speech and of the press
Foreign policy	Racial supremacy & national glory; supported expansion	Adopted an appeasement policy when facing problems

(i) Italy — Fascism (Mussolini)

- **Rise:** Italy lost confidence in its government and democracy → opportunity for Mussolini and the Fascist Party.
- **Regime:** founded the Fascist Party (1921); became Prime Minister (1922, after the March on Rome); banned all other parties; by 1928 established Fascist dictatorial rule.

Seven features of Fascist rule:

1 One-party dictatorship	All parties banned except the Fascist Party
2 Absolute obedience	All people must work for the country and obey the state
3 Total control & oppression	State controlled daily life, work, education; secret police
4 Cult of personality	"Mussolini is always right"
5 Anti-communism	Suppressed socialist and communist activities
6 Economic self-sufficiency	Reduced reliance on foreign countries
7 Military & territorial expansion	Expanded the military to revive the glory of ancient Rome

(ii) Germany — Nazism (Hitler)

- **Rise:** the Weimar Republic was unpopular for signing the Treaty of Versailles; in the Depression unemployment passed 6 million. Hitler promised jobs and to overthrow the Treaty → mass support.
- **Regime:** 1932 the Nazi Party became the largest in parliament; 1933 Hitler became Chancellor; 1934 he became Chancellor and President with absolute power, banned other parties, and set up a one-party dictatorship.

History in Depth — Rise of Hitler

WWI soldier → joined the German Workers' Party → reorganised as the Nazi Party (1920); Hitler became leader (1921).

1923 Beer Hall Putsch (Munich) failed; he was imprisoned and wrote Mein Kampf (first volume published 1925).

Six features of Nazi rule:

1 One-party dictatorship	All parties banned except the Nazi Party
2 Total control & oppression	State controlled daily life, work, education; secret police
3 Cult of personality	Hitler called Führer (leader); media controlled; glorified as a hero
4 Anti-Semitism	Believed the Aryan race superior; persecuted Jews — about 6 million Jews died
5 Anti-communism	Suppressed all communist activities
6 Military & territorial expansion	Sought 'living space'; aimed at a Greater German Empire

(iii) Japan — Militarism

- **Rise:** militarism = belief in military power and expansion for national interests. After WWI, party government was corrupt and failed to solve the Depression → people supported the militarists.
- **Regime:** 1931 the army invaded Manchuria and set up the puppet state Manchouguo (1932); 1932 the party government fell; militarists set up a military dictatorship.

Five features of militarist rule:

1 Military dictatorship	From 1932 the military controlled the cabinet; opposition silenced by force
2 Control of thought & emperor worship	Emperor-centred nationalism; school textbooks promoted war & emperor worship
3 Anti-communism	Communist ideas (e.g. abolishing the Tenno system) seen as a threat to national unity
4 Military & territorial expansion	Sought territory & markets; expanded in China and Southeast Asia
5 State control	From the 1937 invasion of China, all resources controlled; whole nation mobilised

The three regimes at a glance — Party · Leader · Symbol

A quick way to remember each regime is the **Party (ideology) – Leader – Symbol** triangle:



The three totalitarian regimes: Fascism (Italy), Nazism (Germany) & Militarism (Japan)

Each triangle links the ruling Party/ideology, its Leader, and its Symbol. (Japan: Shintoism as the state religion; leaders Tojo Hideki & Emperor Showa.)

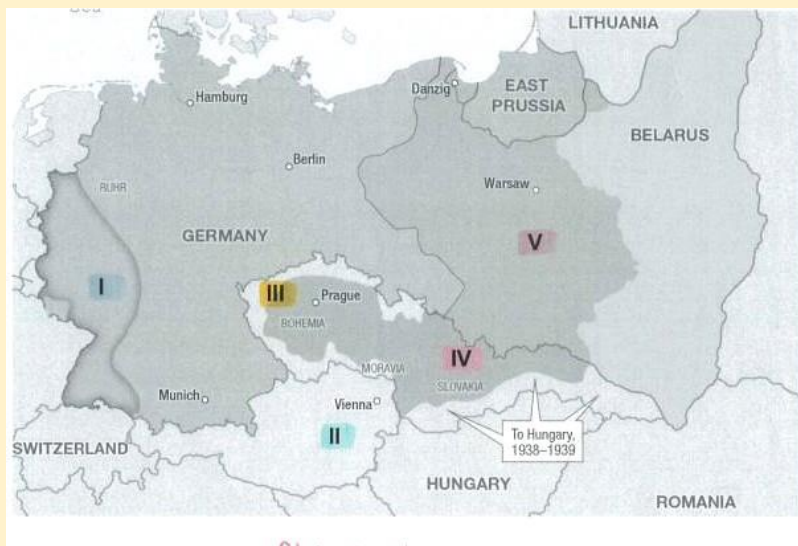
A5 · Aggressions of the totalitarian states in the 1930s (pp. 36–38)

In the 1930s Italy, Germany and Japan actively expanded in Africa, Europe and Asia, causing many international crises.

Italy in Africa

Date	Event
Oct 1935 – May 1936	Italy invaded Abyssinia (NE Africa) and annexed it

◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 10: Germany's expansion in Europe (answers)



- I. Remilitarisation of the **Rhineland** 萊茨地區 (March 1936) — violated the **Treaty of Versailles**.
- II. **Anschluss** 德奧合併 (March 1938) — annexation of Austria into Germany.
- III. Sudetenland Crisis 蘇台德危機 (Sept 1938) — occupied the Sudetenland (NW **Czechoslovakia**); the **Munich Agreement** 慕尼黑協定 was signed.
- IV. German invasion of **Czechoslovakia** (March 1939) — Britain & France abolished the **appeasement** policy.
- V. German invasion of **Poland** (Sept 1939) — the Nazi–Soviet **Non-Aggression Pact** was signed; start of the **Second World War**.

◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 9: Japan's expansion in Asia (answers)



1. **Shenyang (Mukden) Incident** 九一八事變 (1931) — Japanese troops invaded Manchuria.
2. Attacked **Shanghai** (1932) — retreated under pressure from Britain, France and the US.
3. Establishment of **Manzhouguo (Manchukuo)** 滿洲國 (1932).
4. **Lugouqiao (Marco Polo Bridge) Incident** 蘆溝橋事變 (1937) — invaded Peking; start of the full-scale invasion of China.
5. The **Second Sino-Japanese War** 抗日戰爭 (1937–1945).

Formation of the Axis Powers

- **1936**: Germany & Japan signed the Anti-Comintern Pact (against the communist Soviet Union); Italy joined in 1937.
- **May 1939**: Germany & Italy signed the Pact of Steel (military alliance).
- **Sept 1940**: Germany, Italy & Japan signed the Tripartite Pact — the 'Berlin–Rome–Tokyo Axis'. In WWII the Axis fought the Allies.

A6 · Attempts at collective security and their failure (pp. 40–43)

(i) Setbacks of the League of Nations

- At its peak the League had 58 members, but **the United States never joined**.
- It settled many disputes in the 1920s but failed to stop the totalitarian states in the 1930s; Japan and Italy intensified aggression and withdrew. Its failure encouraged Germany; members lost faith in collective security.

State	Failure of the League
Japan	1931 invaded NE China; the League condemned it but Japan ignored the demand and left in 1933
Germany	1933 Hitler in power; Germany left the Geneva Disarmament Conference and the League
Italy	1935 invaded Abyssinia; League sanctions failed to gain support; Italy occupied Abyssinia (1936) and left the next year

(ii) Appeasement policy of Britain and France

- **Definition:** making concessions to an aggressor state to prevent war.
- **Why:** they wanted to focus on internal problems and were not strong enough for military intervention.
- Towards Japan & Italy: took no real action over China (1931); secretly agreed to let Italy take two-thirds of Abyssinia; refused to enforce League sanctions.
- Towards Germany: took no action over the Rhineland (1936) and Austria (1938). In Sept 1938 they signed the **Munich Agreement**, letting Germany take the Sudetenland.

(iii) Isolationism of the United States

- After the Paris Peace Conference the US returned to isolationism and did not join the League; the Depression deepened this.
- 1935: passed the first **Neutrality Act** (no arms exports to nations at war). US isolationism encouraged totalitarian aggression.

(iv) The Soviet Union drawn closer to Germany

- The communist USSR (est. 1922) was distrusted by the West and not invited to the Munich Conference; Stalin feared Britain & France wanted to turn Germany against the USSR.
- 1939: the **Nazi–Soviet Non-Aggression Pact** — Germany & the USSR secretly agreed to divide Poland and Eastern Europe. This removed the main obstacle to German expansion eastward.

A7 · Events leading to war & the immediate cause (p. 45)

- **Further expansion (March–April 1939):** Germany occupied the whole of Czechoslovakia; Italy occupied Albania. Britain & France abandoned appeasement, promised to protect Poland, and accelerated armaments.
- **Immediate cause — German invasion of Poland (Sept 1939):** Germany demanded land Poland had gained by the Treaty of Versailles; Poland refused. Encouraged by the Nazi–Soviet Pact (and believing Britain & France would not fight), Germany attacked Poland on 1 Sept 1939. Britain & France declared war — the Second World War began.

A8 · Summary: Was WWII a continuation of WWI?

Yes — the two wars were closely related. The chain of causes:

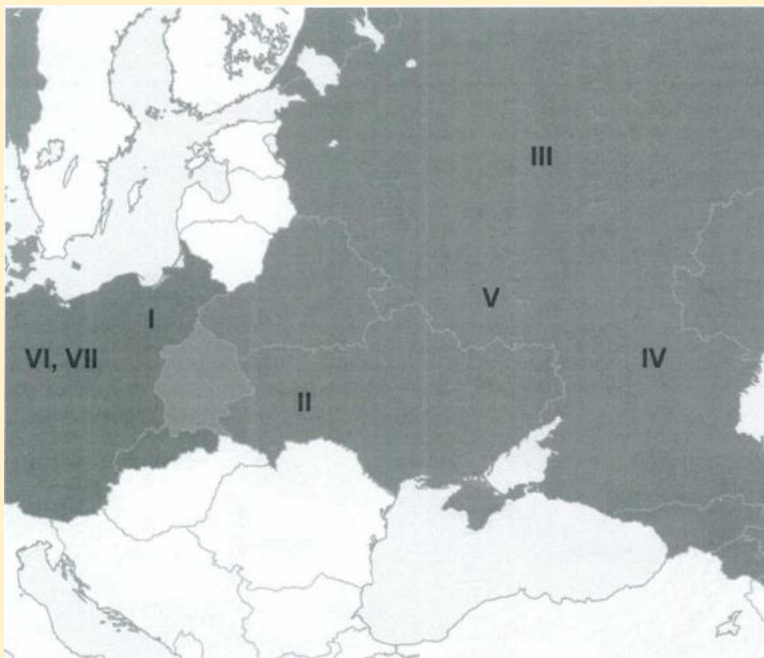
#	Link in the chain
1	Problems left by WWI: discontent of Germany & Italy with the settlements; weak new nation-states; post-war economic downturn
2	Desire for revenge & loss of faith in democracy → Italy first to set up a totalitarian government
3	The Great Depression deepened the crisis → totalitarian governments in Germany and Japan
4	In the 1930s the totalitarian states launched aggressions; Germany called for the overthrow of the Treaty of Versailles
5	Responses of other powers: Britain & France appeased; the US chose isolationism; the USSR drew closer to Germany
6	These weak responses encouraged further aggression; continuous aggression led to the outbreak of WWII

PART B — The Second World War: the fighting & its impact

The war had two main theatres: the **Eastern Front** in Europe (Germany vs the USSR) and the **Asia-Pacific theatre** (Japan vs China, the US, Britain). This part covers both (from Revision Exercises 11–12), the incidents in chronological order, and the impact of the war (DBQ 3).

B1 · The Eastern Front (Europe)

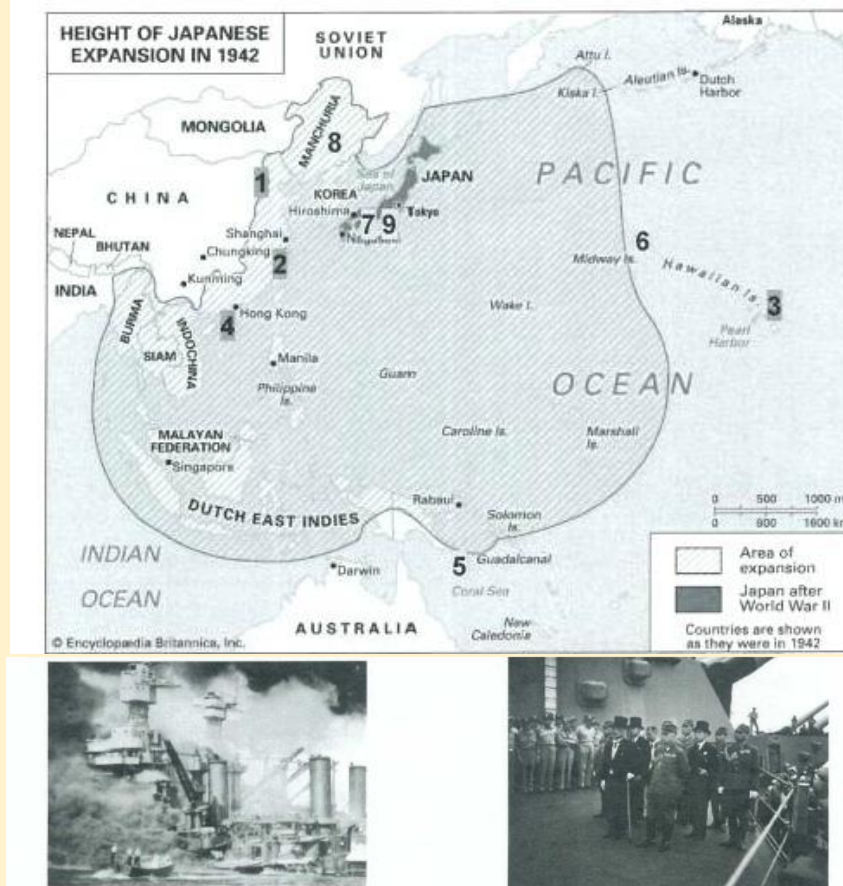
◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 11: The Eastern Front (answers)



- I. German invasion of **Poland** (Sept 1939) — Britain & France declared war; WWII broke out.
- II. **Operation Barbarossa** (1941) — Germany invaded the **Soviet Union**.
- III. Battle of **Moscow** (1941–42) — ended the idea of a fast German victory.
- IV. Battle of **Stalingrad** (1942–43) — first major defeat of the German troops.
- V. Battle of **Kursk** (1943) — largest **tank battle** in history; Germany lost the ability to launch strategic offensives.
- VI. Battle of **Berlin** (1945) — a month of street-by-street fighting.
- VII. Unconditional surrender of Germany (May 1945) — end of WWII in Europe.

B2 · The Asia-Pacific Theatre

◆ FINAL REVISION NOTES — Research Exercise 12: The Asia-Pacific Theatre (answers)



Pearl Harbour Incident

The surrender of Japan

1. **Marco Polo Bridge (Lugouqiao) Incident** (July 1937) — took Peking & Tianjin; start of the Second Sino-Japanese War.
2. **Nanjing Massacre** (Dec 1937) — over 200,000 Chinese civilians & captured soldiers killed.
3. **Pearl Harbour Incident** (9 Dec 1941) — surprise attack on the US naval base; the Pacific War broke out.
4. Battle of **Hong Kong** (Dec 1941) — Britain lost HK in 3 weeks; Japan also took Malaya & Singapore.
5. Battle of the **Coral Sea** (May 1942) — Japanese advance stopped for the first time.
6. Battle of **Midway** (June 1942) — turning point; all four Japanese carriers destroyed.
7. Atomic bombings of Hiroshima & **Nagasaki** (6 & 9 Aug 1945) — over 200,000 Japanese killed.
8. Soviet invasion of Manchuria (Aug 1945) — Japan's **Kwantung** Army defeated.
9. Unconditional surrender of Japan (15 Aug 1945) — the Second World War ended.

B3 · Important WWII incidents in chronological order

Combining both theatres (Research Exercises 9–12) into one timeline. **Eu** = European / Eastern Front; **AP** = Asia-Pacific.

Date	Incident	Theatre
7 July 1937	Lugouqiao (Marco Polo Bridge) Incident — full-scale Second Sino-Japanese War begins	AP
Dec 1937	Nanjing Massacre	AP
1 Sept 1939	German invasion of Poland — Britain & France declared war; WWII broke out	Eu
1941	Operation Barbarossa — Germany invaded the Soviet Union	Eu
1941–42	Battle of Moscow — ended the idea of a fast German victory	Eu
7–9 Dec 1941	Pearl Harbour Incident — Pacific War broke out; Battle of Hong Kong	AP
May 1942	Battle of the Coral Sea — Japanese advance stopped for the first time	AP
June 1942	Battle of Midway — turning point of the Pacific War	AP
1942–43	Battle of Stalingrad — first major defeat of German troops (turning point)	Eu
1943	Battle of Kursk — largest tank battle in history	Eu
May 1945	Battle of Berlin; unconditional surrender of Germany — end of WWII in Europe	Eu
6 & 9 Aug 1945	Atomic bombings of Hiroshima & Nagasaki	AP
Aug 1945	Soviet invasion of Manchuria — Japan's Kwantung Army defeated	AP
15 Aug 1945	Unconditional surrender of Japan — the Second World War ended	AP

EXAM FOCUS — Two turning points to memorise

Eastern Front: Stalingrad (1942–43) — first major German defeat. **Asia-Pacific:** Midway (June 1942) — all four Japanese carriers destroyed.

B4 · The impact of the Second World War (DBQ 3)

DBQ 3 asks about the **impact of the Second World War**, using **Source A** (total deaths in WWI vs WWII) and **Source B** (the atomic bombs).

(i) Total deaths: WWI vs WWII (Source A)

	First World War	Second World War
Total deaths	about 19 million	about 85 million (4× larger)
Worst-hit country	Russia — about 3.3 million	Soviet Union — about 27 million

- **Similarity:** Russia / the Soviet Union suffered the most in both wars (the highest death toll of all countries).
- **Difference:** the Second World War was far deadlier — about 85 million deaths, roughly four times the First World War's ~19 million.

(ii) Why was the Second World War deadlier?

- **Larger area of fighting:** the war was not confined to Europe — the Asia-Pacific region was also a major battlefield.
- **More destructive weapons:** new weapons such as the **atomic bomb** (used by the US on Hiroshima & Nagasaki) caused destruction on a scale never seen before.

(iii) The three main impacts (DBQ 3 model answer)

#	Impact	Evidence / explanation
1	Casualties & destruction	Over 85 million people were killed (Source A); cities and economies were devastated.
2	Start of the nuclear age	The atomic bomb was first invented and used by the United States in 1945 (Source B), destroying Hiroshima & Nagasaki. Afterwards the world's nuclear stockpiles grew.
3	Rise of two superpowers & decline of Europe	The United States and the Soviet Union extended their global influence and rose as superpowers. European powers (e.g. France & Britain) lost most of their colonies and became second-rank powers.

PART C — Wars and inventions (pp. 64–79)

How the two world wars changed warfare and brought new technology.

C1 · Change in the mode of warfare: total war (pp. 64–67)

(a) The two world wars became total wars

- In WWI neither side could win quickly; the stalemate and new technology turned it into a total war (also used in WWII).
- **Total war** = warfare not confined to the front line; countries mobilised all resources in the rear (manpower, farming, industry) for a long war.

(b) Features of total war (Source 9.42)

Countries controlled and mobilised all national resources; policies were military-oriented; the line between combatants and non-combatants disappeared, so civilians became targets too.

Area	Wartime measures / strategy	Aim
Military	Bombers, missiles, nuclear weapons on population centres; unlimited submarine warfare	Destroy enemy armaments, production & morale; hit foreign trade
Economic	Nationalised arms factories; war bonds; printed banknotes; forced labour (incl. women); food rationing	Supply the armed forces; raise war funds; keep up production
Political	Expanded government powers; suppressed opposition; propaganda	Mobilise resources; reduce opposition; gain popular support
Social/cultural	Conscription; censored mass media	Deploy human resources; guard military secrets

(c) Impacts of total war on people

- **Political — loss of freedom:** nationalised private firms; people lost property rights and freedom of employment, speech, publication and communication.
- **Economic — disruption:** shortages of daily goods; massive note-printing caused inflation; failed food rationing in WWI Germany led to famine.
- **Social — heavier civilian casualties:** the home front became a battlefield; in WWI civilians were over one-tenth of war deaths.
- **Social — rise in women's position:** women joined farming/industry and even the military; after the wars they won the right to vote and became more economically independent.

C2 · New armaments & three-dimensional warfare (pp. 68–72)

WWI saw the rise of **three-dimensional warfare** — land, sea and air.

Dimension	WWI armaments
Land	• Trench warfare; • tanks (Britain first to use them); • machine guns; • toxic gas; • grenades
Sea	• Dreadnoughts (most powerful warships; 40+ in the 1916 Anglo-German war); • German submarines = 'U-boats' sank neutral ships heading to Britain
Air	• Fighter planes (spying, dogfights, later air raids) • Zeppelins — aerial bombing became a key modern strategy

WWII was also fought in three dimensions, with improved weapons and new ones:

- **Nuclear weapons:** the US was first to have atomic bombs; in 1945 it dropped them on Hiroshima & Nagasaki, forcing Japan's unconditional surrender.
- **Bomber aircraft:** long-range bombing of enemy rear installations, factories and cities; some carried nuclear weapons.
- **Rockets:** in 1944 Germany launched unmanned V-2 rockets at British cities across the English Channel.
- **Aircraft carriers:** carried fighters/bombers for air support and long-range attacks (e.g. the 1942 US bombing of Tokyo).

Impacts of military innovations

- **Unprecedented casualties:** the most destructive wars in history — over 80 million killed (WWI ≈ 20 M; WWII ≈ 80 M). Toxic gas & nuclear weapons had long-term health effects.
- **Huge economic losses:** WWI ≈ USD 330 billion; WWII ≈ USD 1,000 billion in damage.
- **Continuing threats to peace:** atomic bombs began the nuclear era; in the Cold War the US & USSR built even more destructive hydrogen bombs.

C3 · Technological innovations brought by the wars (pp. 73–78)

Military needs drove new technology that was later put to civilian use. **Remember at least two examples per category.**

Category	Innovation — origin & civilian use
Aviation & aerospace	• Jet engine (1939, German designer Heinkel; civilian jets from 1949 → faster air travel). • Rocket engine (WWII German rockets → 1950s US/USSR space age: 1957 first satellite, 1961 first astronaut, 1981 US shuttle Columbia)
Info & communications	• Radar (WWII Allied detection → navigation, weather, monitoring). • Computer (US 'ENIAC', the world's first computer / 'Giant Brain' → business & personal computers from the 1970s)
Materials	• Cellucotton (1914, Kimberly-Clark; battlefields → tissue & toilet paper). • Stainless steel (British scientist Brearley; resists corrosion → tableware, pipes, building material)
Medicine	• Plastic surgery (WWI doctor Gillies, 'father of modern plastic surgery'). • Penicillin (mass-produced by the US in WWII; Fleming discovered it in 1928)
Daily tools	• Zipper (improved 1914 by Sundback; WWI uniforms → everyday use). • Waterproof clothing (Burberry's 'trench coat' → the windbreaker)
Energy	Nuclear energy (1942 US Manhattan Project; Fermi built the first reactor in Chicago → nuclear power, ≈ 16% of world power by 1999)

History in Depth — Nuclear accidents (p. 78–79)

Nuclear waste is dangerous and accidents cause disasters:

Chernobyl (1986, Ukraine): a leak forced hundreds of thousands to evacuate; pollutants spread to Western Europe & North America.

Fukushima Daiichi (2011, Japan): a tsunami caused a massive radiation leak; nuclear safety again became a global concern.

PART D — The Berlin Blockade map (p. 122)

Coverage note: only the map of p. 122 is in scope.

Quick context (for reading the map only): after WWII, Germany and Berlin were each split into four occupation zones (US, Britain, France, USSR). Berlin sat deep inside the Soviet zone. During the 1948–49 Berlin Blockade the USSR cut land/water routes into West Berlin; the Western powers supplied it by air through the marked air corridors.



Map (Source 10.11): Administration of Berlin & the Berlin Blockade (1948–49)

KEY — blue: American zone; green: British zone; orange: French zone; pink: Soviet zone; arrows: air corridors.



Inset map: Berlin divided into West Berlin & East Berlin

West Berlin (US/British/French zones) lay surrounded by the Soviet zone; the dashed line marks the West Berlin boundary.

Appendix 1 — Chronology (1919–1945)

Year	Event	Why it matters
1919	Paris Peace Conference; Germany signed the Treaty of Versailles; Weimar Republic set up	Sowed the seeds of Nazism (Germany) & Fascism (Italy)
1920	League of Nations established	World's first international peacekeeping body
1922	Mussolini became PM (March on Rome)	Italy moved towards Fascist rule
1928	Fascist dictatorship established in Italy	Italy's threat to peace deepened
1929	Wall Street Crash → Great Depression	Fuelled totalitarianism; weakened Britain & France
1931	Japan invaded NE China	Totalitarian aggression; League & appeasement failed
1932	Japan set up Manzhouguo	Japan's threat deepened
1933	Hitler became Chancellor	Germany left the League
1934	Hitler gained absolute power	Nazi dictatorship established
1935	Italy invaded Abyssinia	League sanctions failed
1936	Germany re-entered the Rhineland; Anti-Comintern Pact (Ger–Jpn)	Treaty of Versailles violated; Axis forming
1937	Lugouqiao Incident — full-scale invasion of China; Italy joined Anti-Comintern Pact	Second Sino-Japanese War begins
1938	Anschluss (Austria); Munich Agreement (Sudetenland)	High point of appeasement
1939	Germany took all of Czechoslovakia; Nazi–Soviet Pact; invasion of Poland (1 Sept)	Appeasement abandoned; WWII broke out
1940	Tripartite Pact — Berlin–Rome–Tokyo Axis	Axis Powers formed
1941	Operation Barbarossa; Pearl Harbour (Dec)	USSR & US drawn into the war
1942	Coral Sea; Midway	Turning points (Pacific)
1943	Stalingrad; Kursk	Turning points (Eastern Front)
1945	Berlin falls; Germany surrenders (May); atomic bombs; Japan surrenders (15 Aug)	End of the Second World War

Appendix 2 — Key terms glossary

Term	Meaning
Paris Peace Conference (1919)	Conference held by the victors after WWI; applied national self-determination and set up collective security, but its settlements sowed the seeds of new conflict.
'Big Three'	Wilson (US), Lloyd George (Britain) and Clemenceau (France), who dominated the conference.
Treaty of Versailles (1919)	Peace treaty with Germany: disarm, pay reparations, cede land, accept the war-guilt clause. German resentment helped cause WWII.
War-guilt clause	Clause forcing Germany to accept full responsibility for the war — the basis of the other terms.
National self-determination	The idea that a people with a common language and culture may form their own state and choose their own government.
League of Nations (1920)	First international peacekeeping body; aimed to keep peace through collective security but the US never joined and it failed in the 1930s.
The Great Depression	Global economic slump after the 1929 Wall Street Crash; spread worldwide because the US was Europe's main creditor.
Totalitarianism	System in which the ruler holds total authority and controls all public and private life.
Fascism	Totalitarianism in Italy under Mussolini and the Fascist Party.
Nazism	Totalitarianism in Germany under Hitler and the Nazi Party.
Anti-Semitism	Nazi hostility to Jews; about 6 million Jews died under Nazi persecution to 'preserve' the Aryan race.
Militarism	Totalitarianism in Japan; belief in military power and expansion for national interests.
The Rhineland	Demilitarized zone after WWI; German troops re-entered it in 1936, violating the Treaty of Versailles.
Appeasement policy	Britain & France making concessions to aggressors to avoid war; failed to prevent WWII.
Munich Agreement (1938)	Britain, France & Italy let Germany take the Sudetenland — the prime example of appeasement.
Nazi–Soviet Non-Aggression Pact (1939)	Germany & the USSR secretly agreed to divide Poland and Eastern Europe; cleared the way for the invasion of Poland.
Axis & Allied Powers	WWII rival camps: Axis = Germany, Italy, Japan; Allies = Britain, France, US, USSR, China.
Total war	Warfare in which a country mobilises all its resources and the home front becomes part of the battlefield.